it is who says such things, the person who makes them say it is always a Naamdar. Everything happens at their signal, Congress knows everything at whose saying it happens, in a party where no one can say a word otherwise … When the election in Gujarat was happening, even then there was a big attack regarding my caste. Then when they saw the people's anger, he [Gohil] was suspended and then after two months they hugged him again.

OBCs and Caste Policy Moves by the Modi Government

The BJP accompanied its state-level moves on caste with parallel moves at the national level, which form the focal point of the party's political messaging to OBCs. Parallel to the Yogi Adityanath government's appointment of a panel to reorganise OBC reservations in 2017, the Union government under Modi set up a similar five-member commission. Headed by former chief justice of the Delhi High Court, Justice G. Rohini, it was tasked in October 2017 with deciding how to further sub-divide the 27 per cent quota among the 2,400-plus OBC castes (which range across five broad categories) nationally.[41] The Rohini Commission was initially asked to finish its work in twelve weeks, but has received several extensions since, the latest one being a six-month extension in July 2021.[42] Additionally, the National Commission for Backward Classes (NCBC) was given constitutional status by an act of Parliament in August 2018.[43] This constitutional change happened towards the end of the first Modi government. However, earlier, after consultation with nine states, the commission had also submitted a detailed report to the government on the sub-categorisation of OBCs nationally.[44] It asked the government for permission to implement this work nationwide. Much like the state-level report submitted in UP, this recommendation was pending with the government at the time of writing. Yet, its political potential was obvious.

The change in the status of the Backward Classes Commission is a theme that has constantly featured in Modi's election speeches ever since. Speaking in Dhanbad during the Jharkhand election campaign in December 2019, for example, he declaimed that the